

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in
Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus
applies

Statement under examination

There is one God eternally existing in three coequal, coeternal, distinct Persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

In plain language

This proposition says God is one and that Scripture names that one God as three distinct persons, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit. The words support this, but in a particular way: no single verse states the whole idea, yet the vocabulary and grammar each supply a piece, and the pieces only fit together one way. On oneness, Deuteronomy 6:4 calls the LORD one using the ordinary number 'one' (echad, the Hebrew cardinal number), the same word used for the 'one flesh' of a married pair, and not the word for solitary or only ('yachid', the Hebrew word for sole or alone) that Hebrew also had. So oneness is asserted, but with a word that does not by itself rule out internal distinction. On the three, Matthew 28:19 says to baptize into a single 'name' ('onoma', the noun is grammatically singular in Greek) which is then spelled out as three persons, each with its own 'the' and joined by 'and' ('kai' in Greek): the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit. The blessing at 2 Corinthians 13:14 lines up the same three side by side. On the full deity of each, John 1:1 says the Word ('logos' in Greek) was with God and the Word was God ('theos' in Greek), using one verb tense ('en', an imperfect of 'to be' meaning ongoing past existence) that places the Word before creation and a grammar that distinguishes the Word from the God he is with while still calling him God. In Acts 5:3 to 4, lying to the Holy Spirit ('pneuma' in Greek) is restated one verse later as lying to God. In John 14:16 to 17 the Son asks, the Father gives, and the Spirit comes, three named ones in one breath, and the Spirit is given personal verbs of knowing and abiding. The pattern runs across the law, the Gospels, Acts, and a letter, and is not disturbed by textual variants in the available data. Readers diverge here for one plain reason: the words clearly give oneness, threeness, and the full deity of each, but they never give the single word that ties them together, so people differ over whether that tie is required or merely allowed.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	אֶחָד	echad	one	970
H0430	אֱלֹהִים	elohim	God	2,598
H0559	אָמַר	amar	to say	
H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	
H1823	דְּמוּת	demut	likeness	
H3173	יָחִיד	yachid	only	12
H6213	עָשָׂה	asah	to make	2,632

H6754	דָּלָה	tselem	image	
G0225	ἀλήθεια	alētheia	truth	
G0243	ἄλλος	allos	another	154
G0907	βαπτίζω	baptizō	to baptize	
G1097	γινώσκω	ginōskō	to know	
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	2,457
G2087	ἕτερος	heteros	other	
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,307
G2334	θεωρέω	theōreō	to see/experience	
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	339
G3306	μένω	menō	to stay	
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	229
G3875	παράκλητος	parakletos	counsellor	5
G3962	πατήρ	pater	father	426
G4151	πνεῦμα	pneuma	spirit/breath	379
G5574	ψεύδομαι	pseudomai	to lie	12

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The proposition is a synthesis of three components, and the canon supplies each component with grammar that forecloses the alternatives, though no single verse states the integrated whole. Oneness: Deuteronomy 6:4 predicates 'one' (אֶחָד, echad, Strong's H0259, morph HAcmsa, the ordinary cardinal one, 970 occurrences, the same form used for the composite 'one flesh' of Genesis 2:24) of the LORD (יְהוָה, YHWH), and 'God' (אֱלֹהִים, elohim, Strong's H0430, morph HNcmpa, masculine plural in form in 2597 of 2598 occurrences) takes singular concord (the verb and adjectives agreeing with it are singular, treating the plural-form noun as one). Threeness with deity of each: Matthew 28:19 governs three articulated genitives (nouns in the 'of-X' grammatical form each carrying the article 'the'): 'of the Father' (τοῦ πατρὸς, tou patros, N-GSM, noun-genitive-singular-masculine), 'of the Son' (τοῦ υἱοῦ, tou huiou, N-GSM), 'of the Holy Spirit' (τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος, tou hagiou pneumatōs, N-GSN, noun-genitive-singular-neuter), each with its own article and joined by 'and' (καί, kai), under one singular 'name' (ὄνομα, onoma, Strong's G3686, N-ASN, noun-accusative-singular-neuter). The benediction at 2 Corinthians 13:14 (versified 2 Corinthians 13:13 in the SBLGNT, an editor's critical edition of the Greek New Testament) coordinates the same three by 'and' (καί). Acts 5:3 to 5:4 names lying to 'the Holy Spirit' (τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον, to pneuma to hagion) then restates it 'you have not lied to men but to God' (οὐκ ἐψεύσω ἀνθρώποις ἀλλὰ τῷ θεῷ, ouk eapseuso anthropois alla to theo), equating the Spirit with God. John 1:1 sets 'the Word' (ὁ λόγος, ho logos) 'with God' (πρὸς τὸν θεόν, pros ton theon, with the article 'the', T-ASM, marking distinction) against the article-less predicate 'God' (anarthrous, that is, without the article 'the': θεὸς ἦν ὁ λόγος, theos en ho logos, N-NSM, noun-nominative-singular-masculine, qualitative nature). John 14:16 to 17 holds three referents in one breath and gives the Spirit personal verbs. The pattern spans Torah (the first five books of Moses), the Gospels, Acts, and an epistle (a New Testament letter), and is variant-stable in the bundle (the wording is solid across the textual evidence we have), so pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) and variant-robust (not destabilized by textual variants) hold.

Scripture

Deut.6.4 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H0430 אלהים, H0259 אחד.

Reasoning. 'Hear, O Israel, the LORD our God, the LORD is one' (שמע ישראל יהוה אחד, shema yisrael YHWH eloheinu YHWH echad). The Shema (the Hebrew name of this confession, from the opening word 'hear') fixes the oneness pole. 'Our God' (אלהינו, eloheinu, Strong's H0430) carries morph HNcmppc with a 1cp suffix (first common plural possessive 'our'), a noun masculine plural in form taking singular concord (the verb and adjectives agreeing with it are singular) with 'the LORD' (יהוה, YHWH). The predicate 'one' (אחד, echad, Strong's H0259, morph HAcmsa) is the ordinary cardinal one, attested 970 times, the same form that describes the composite 'one flesh' of Genesis 2:24. Hebrew had a distinct word for solitary aloneness, 'only' or 'sole' (יחיד, yachid, Strong's H3173, only 12 occurrences, the 'only son' of Genesis 22:2), and the Shema does not use it. So the text asserts numeric oneness with a word that does not, of itself, exclude internal plurality, while not asserting that plurality either.

Gen.1.26 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H0430 אלהים, H6213 עשה, H6754 צלם, H1823 דמות.

Reasoning. 'And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness' (ויאמר אלהים נעשה אדם בצלמנו: כדמותנו, vayomer elohim na'aseh adam betsalmenu kidmutenu). The verb of speech 'and he said' (ויאמר, vayomer, Strong's H0559) is morph HC/Vqw3ms, third masculine singular (one male speaker, completed past), so the speaker is one. The inner-speech verb 'let us make' (נעשה, na'aseh, Strong's H6213) is morph HVqi1cp, first common plural cohortative (a 'let us' form, group self-encouragement), and the suffixes on 'in our image' (בצלמנו, betsalmenu) and 'after our likeness' (כדמותנו, kidmutenu) are Sp1cp ('our'). The next verse executes the act in the singular: 'and he created' (ויברא, vayivra, Strong's H1254, Vqw3ms, third masculine singular completed past) 'in his image' (בצלמו, betsalmo), suffix Sp3ms (third masculine singular 'his'). One speaker uses first-person plural inner discourse ('let us'), then acts in the singular ('he created').

Matt.28.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3686 ὄνομα, G3962 πατήρ

Reasoning. 'baptizing them into the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit' (βαπτίζοντες αὐτοὺς εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ πατρὸς καὶ τοῦ υἱοῦ καὶ τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος, baptizontes autous eis to onoma tou patros kai tou huiou kai tou hagiou pneumatos). The noun 'name' (ὄνομα, onoma, Strong's G3686) is morph N-ASN, singular (noun-accusative-singular-neuter), with its article 'the' (τό, to) also singular (T-ASN, article-accusative-singular-neuter), governed by the preposition 'into' (εἰς, eis). It is not 'names' (ὀνόματα, onomata, plural). Three articulated genitives (nouns in the 'of-X' grammatical form each carrying 'the') follow, each with its own article and joined by 'and' (καί, kai): 'of the Father' (τοῦ πατρὸς, tou patros, T-GSM article-genitive-singular-masculine, N-GSM noun-genitive-singular-masculine), 'of the Son' (τοῦ υἱοῦ, tou huiou, T-GSM, N-GSM), 'of the Holy Spirit' (τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος, tou hagiou pneumatos, T-GSN article-genitive-singular-neuter, A-GSN adjective-genitive-singular-neuter, N-GSN noun-genitive-singular-neuter). The single name resists splitting into three names, and the three distinct articles and conjunctions resist collapsing the three into one undifferentiated referent.

2Cor.13.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2316 θεός, G4151 πνεῦμα

Reasoning. 'The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit' (ἡ χάρις τοῦ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ καὶ ἡ ἀγάπη τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἡ κοινωνία τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος, he charis tou kuriou Iesou Christou kai he agape tou theou kai he koinonia tou hagiou pneumatos). Stored at the SBLGNT (an editor's critical edition of the Greek New Testament) versification 2 Corinthians 13:13, the benediction coordinates three genitive phrases (nouns in the 'of-X' form) by 'and' (καί, kai): 'of the Lord Jesus Christ' (τοῦ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, tou kuriou Iesou Christou, N-GSM noun-genitive-singular-masculine chain), 'of God' (τοῦ θεοῦ, tou theou, N-GSM), and 'of the Holy Spirit' (τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος, tou hagiou pneumatos, A-GSN adjective-genitive-singular-neuter, N-GSN noun-genitive-singular-neuter). The Lord Jesus, God, and the Holy Spirit stand on one grammatical level as joint sources of grace, love, and fellowship, naming the same three that Matthew 28:19 binds under one name.

John.1.1 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3056 λόγος, G2316 θεός, G1510 εἰμί

Reasoning. 'In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God' (Ἐν ἀρχῇ ἦν ὁ λόγος, καὶ ὁ λόγος ἦν πρὸς τὸν θεόν, καὶ θεὸς ἦν ὁ λόγος, En arche en ho logos, kai ho logos en pros ton theon, kai theos en ho logos). The verb 'was' (ἦν, en) is morph V-IAI-3S, imperfect (ongoing or repeated past action) of 'to be' (εἰμί, eimi, Strong's G1510), a durative past (continuous existence) paired with 'in the beginning' (ἐν ἀρχῇ, en arche) that places 'the Word' (ὁ λόγος, ho logos) behind any creation horizon (before creation began). 'With God' (πρὸς τὸν θεόν, pros ton theon) uses the preposition 'pros' with the articular accusative (the article 'the' attached) 'the God' (τὸν θεόν, ton theon, T-ASM article-accusative-singular-masculine, N-ASM noun-accusative-singular-masculine), marking relational facing (face-to-face presence) and so distinction. The third clause fronts the anarthrous (article-less, without 'the') predicate 'God' (θεός, theos, N-NSM noun-nominative-singular-masculine) before 'was' (ἦν, en), with the articular subject 'the Word' (ὁ λόγος, ho logos, T-NSM article-nominative-singular-masculine, N-NSM noun-nominative-singular-masculine). The anarthrous fronted predicate nominative (a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement, placed first for emphasis and without the article 'the') predicates divine nature of 'the Word' (ho logos) without identifying him as the same person as 'the God' (ὁ θεός, ho theos) he is with. One nature, two distinct referents, in one verse.

Acts.5.3 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G5574 ψεύδομαι, G4151 πνεῦμα

Reasoning. 'Why has Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit' (διὰ τί ἐπλήρωσεν ὁ Σατανᾶς τὴν καρδίαν σου ψεύσασθαι σε τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον, dia ti eplerosen ho Satanas ten kardian sou pseusasthai se to pneuma to hagion). The infinitive 'to lie' (ψεύσασθαι, pseusasthai, Strong's G5574, V-ADN verb-aorist-deponent-infinitive, an action-verb form) takes 'the Holy Spirit' (τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον, to pneuma to hagion, N-ASN noun-accusative-singular-neuter, with the article 'the') as the one lied to. The Holy Spirit is the personal addressee of a lie, the kind of object only a personal agent can be, not an impersonal influence.

Acts.5.4 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G5574 ψεύδομαι, G2316 θεός

Reasoning. 'You have not lied to men but to God' (οὐκ ἐψεύσω ἀνθρώποις ἀλλὰ τῷ θεῷ, ouk epseuso anthropois alla to theo). One verse after naming the Spirit as the one lied to, Peter restates the same act with 'you have lied' (ἐψεύσω, epseuso, V-ADI-2S, verb-aorist-deponent-indicative-second-person-singular, a completed past action in plain statement form) as lying not 'to men' (ἀνθρώποις, anthropois, N-DPM noun-dative-plural-masculine, the 'to-X' form) but, with the strong adversative 'but' (ἀλλά, alla, CONJ conjunction), 'to God' (τῷ θεῷ, to theo, T-DSM article-dative-singular-masculine, N-DSM noun-dative-singular-masculine). The Spirit and God are referentially equated for this act, while verse 3 and verse 4 still name them as distinct grammatical entities. The 'both-and' pattern of distinction plus shared deity is on the surface of the grammar.

John.14.16 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3962 πατήρ, G0243 ἄλλος

Reasoning. 'And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Helper' (καγὼ ἐρωτήσω τὸν πατέρα καὶ ἄλλον παράκλητον δώσει ὑμῖν, kago eroteso ton patera kai allon parakleton dosei humin). Three referents stand in one sentence: 'and I' (καγὼ, kago), the Son speaking ('I will ask': ἐρωτήσω, eroteso, V-FAI-1S, verb-future-active-indicative-first-person-singular), 'the Father' (τὸν πατέρα, ton patera, N-ASM noun-accusative-singular-masculine), asked, and 'another Helper' (ἄλλον παράκλητον, allon parakleton), 'another Helper' that the Father 'will give' (δώσει, dosei, V-FAI-3S, verb-future-active-indicative-third-person-singular). 'Another' (ἄλλον, allon, Strong's G0243, A-ASM adjective-accusative-singular-masculine) means another of the same kind, distinct from 'heteros' (ἕτερος, heteros), another of a different kind. With 'Helper' or 'Advocate' (παράκλητος, parakletos, Strong's G3875) occurring 5 times, four for the Spirit in John 14 to 16 and once in 1 John 2:1 for Christ as advocate, 'another' (allos) places the coming Helper in the same category as the Helper now speaking.

John.14.17 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0225 ἀλήθεια, G3306 μένω, G1097 γινώσκω

Reasoning. 'the Spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it neither sees him nor knows him. You know him, for he dwells with you and will be in you' (τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας, ὃ ὁ κόσμος οὐ δύναται λαβεῖν ὅτι οὐ θεωρεῖ αὐτὸ οὐδὲ γινώσκει· ὑμεῖς γινώσκετε αὐτό ὅτι παρ' ὑμῖν μένει καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἔσται, to pneuma tes aletheias, ho ho kosmos ou dunatai labein hoti ou theorei auto oude ginoskei; humeis ginokete auto hoti par' humin menei kai en humin estai). 'The Spirit' (τὸ πνεῦμα, to pneuma) takes personal verbs: the world does not 'see' (θεωρεῖ, theorei, V-PAI-3S, verb-present-active-indicative-third-person-singular, ongoing simple statement of fact) or 'know' (γινώσκει, ginoskei, V-PAI-3S) him, the disciples 'know' (γινώσκετε, ginokete, V-PAI-2P, second-person-plural) him, he 'dwells' (μένει, menei, V-PAI-3S) with them and 'will be' (ἔσται, estai, V-FDI-3S, verb-future-deponent-indicative-third-person-singular) in them. The resumptive pronoun 'it/him' (αὐτό, auto, Strong's G0846, P-ASN pronoun-accusative-singular-neuter) is neuter only by grammatical agreement with the neuter noun 'Spirit' (πνεῦμα, pneuma), not by metaphysical signal, and the knowing, abiding, indwelling verbs are personal-agent vocabulary.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
John.1.1	John.1.2	openbible	148
John.1.1	John.10.30	openbible	107
John.1.1	John.1.18	openbible	47
Matt.28.19	Matt.3.16	openbible	36
Matt.28.19	Ps.22.27	openbible	22
Gen.1.26	Gen.3.22	openbible	42
Gen.1.26	Gen.5.1	openbible	40
Gen.1.26	Gen.9.2	openbible	36
John.14.17	John.14.16	openbible	15
Acts.5.4	Acts.5.3	openbible	7
Acts.5.3	Acts.5.9	openbible	6
Acts.5.4	Acts.5.3	tsk	1
Acts.5.3	Acts.5.9	tsk	1
Matt.28.19	Matt.3.16	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Deut.6.4 · addressed

The Shema (Hebrew for 'hear', the opening word of Deuteronomy 6:4) is the strongest oneness text and can be read as flat numeric solitude that excludes any internal distinction. The lexical reply is narrow and honest: the predicate is 'one' (אֶחָד, echad, Strong's H0259), the ordinary cardinal one used 970 times including the composite 'one flesh' of Genesis 2:24, not 'only/sole' (יָחִיד, yachid, Strong's H3173), the solitary 'only' that the language possessed and used elsewhere. So the word affirms numeric oneness but does not, by itself, settle whether that one is internally simple or internally distinct. The oneness pole stands, and it neither establishes nor forbids the threeness the New Testament texts name.

Gen.1.26 · addressed

The plural 'let us make' (נַעֲשֶׂה, na'aseh) and the Sp1cp suffixes (first common plural possessive 'our') are read by some as a plural of majesty (the 'royal we') or as address to a created divine council (a council of created angelic beings). A first-person plural verb of majesty is poorly attested in classical Hebrew prose, and a council reading clashes with verse 27, where God alone executes the act in his own singular image ('in his image': בְּצַלְמוֹ, betsalmo, suffix Sp3ms, third masculine singular 'his'). The same first-person plural divine discourse recurs at Genesis 3:22 (Sp1cp possessive 'our') and Genesis 11:7 ('let us go down, let us confuse': Vqh1cp, first common plural cohortative 'let us' form), so it is a recurring pattern, not a one-off. The grammar fits intra-divine plural speech within one speaker, though it does not by itself name three.

John.14.16 · addressed

The Son asking the Father ('I will ask': ἐρωτήσω, eroteso) can be read as functional subordination (a lower role in the mission) that undercuts coequality. The asking belongs to the incarnate sending discourse (Jesus speaking as the one sent in human flesh), not to the nature claim that John 1:1 already carries ('the Word was God': θεὸς ἦν ὁ λόγος, theos en ho logos). A distinction of role within the mission does not lower the shared nature, so the asking complicates coequality only if mission language is read as nature language.

John.14.17 · addressed

The neuter resumptive pronoun 'it/him' (αὐτό, auto) for 'the Spirit' (τὸ πνεῦμα, to pneuma) is sometimes taken to depersonalize the Spirit. It is mere grammatical concord (agreement in gender) with the neuter noun 'Spirit' (πνεῦμα, pneuma). The personal verbs 'sees' (θεωρεῖ, theorei), 'knows' (γινώσκει, ginoskei), 'dwells' (μένει, menei), 'will be' (ἔσται, estai), and the masculine 'another' (ἄλλον, allon) modifying 'Helper' (παράκλητον, parakleton) construed with the Spirit carry the personal force, so the neuter pronoun does not weigh against personhood.

Concordance traversed

H0259, H3173, H0430, H6213, H6754, H1823, H0559, H1254, G3686, G2316, G3056, G1510, G3962, G4151, G0243, G2087, G3875, G5574, G3306, G1097, G2334, G0907

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The bundle contained zero variant_units and the anchors lie outside the ingested ECM (a critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window (3 John 1:1 to 1:15), so this is 'not in ECM scope'. Matthew 28:19, the 2 Corinthians 13:14 benediction (versified 2 Corinthians 13:13 in SBLGNT and MACULA-Greek, both critical editions of the Greek New Testament), John 1:1, Acts 5:3 to 5:4, and John 14:16 to 17 are textually stable in MACULA-Greek-SBLGNT and MorphGNT (morphology-tagged Greek New Testament editions). Deuteronomy 6:4 and Genesis 1:26 to 27 in OSHB (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible) show no variant touching 'one' (אֶחָד, echad), the cohortative 'let us make' (נַעֲשֶׂה, na'aseh), or the pronominal suffixes ('our').

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

synthesis-mandated: affirms · Each component is lexically forced: oneness (Deuteronomy 6:4 'one' (אֶחָד, echad) over plural-form 'God' (אֱלֹהִים, elohim) with singular concord, the verb and adjectives matching as singular), threeness coordinated as one (singular 'name' (ὄνομα, onoma) over three articular genitives, that is, 'of-X' nouns each carrying 'the', in Matthew 28:19, the threefold 'and' (καί, kai) benediction in 2 Corinthians 13:14), and full deity of each member (John 1:1 'the Word was God' (θεὸς ἦν ὁ λόγος, theos en ho logos), Acts 5:3 to 5:4 Spirit equated with God). When scripture is read with scripture, the only reading that holds all three components without contradiction is one God in three distinct persons. The integration is mandated because no rival reading keeps every clause intact.

synthesis-permitted-not-stated: affirms-with-qualification · This lens grants every component but notes that no single verse states the integrated formula and that the integrating term is supplied by the reader, not the text. On

this reading the canon permits and even favors the triune synthesis but does not state it in one place, so the doctrine is a sound inference rather than an explicit proposition. The lexical data is the same; the claim is only about where the integrating step lives.

strict-unitarian-monadic: does-not-affirm · Read in its strongest form, this lens takes Deuteronomy 6:4 'one' (אֶחָד, echad) as numeric solitude, reads the Genesis 1:26 plural ('let us make': נָשָׂא, na'aseh) as majesty (royal 'we') or council (created angelic beings), treats John 1:1 anarthrous (article-less) 'God' (θεός, theos) as qualitative or lesser rather than full deity, and treats the Matthew 28:19 and 2 Corinthians 13:14 triads as ranked rather than coequal. It must, however, absorb Acts 5:3 to 5:4, where lying to the Spirit is restated as lying to God, and the durative pre-creation 'was' (ἦν, en, ongoing past existence before creation) of John 1:1, which strain a purely monadic (single-undifferentiated) reading. Recorded so the minority reading is represented in its strongest lexical form.

The verdict rests on grammatical and lexical observations within the cited verses, read with scripture interpreting scripture. The divergence among lenses is not over the data but over whether the integrating synthesis is mandated, merely permitted, or resisted. Progressive revelation (the idea that God reveals truth in stages across the canon) is in play in that the plural inner-discourse ('let us': נָשָׂא, na'aseh) and plural-form 'God' (אֱלֹהִים, elohim) of the Torah (the first five books of Moses) are named and specified by the New Testament triadic (three-way) texts.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem uses the confessional shorthand 'one God, three coequal coeternal distinct Persons'. The terms coequal (equal in essence), coeternal (equally without beginning or end), and Person are post-canonical vocabulary (words developed after the Bible was written), but the lexical referents are scriptural: numeric oneness in Deuteronomy 6:4 ('one' (אֶחָד, echad), not 'only/sole' (יָחִיד, yachid)), one singular 'name' (ὄνομα, onoma) over three articular persons in Matthew 28:19, the threefold benediction in 2 Corinthians 13:14, the equation of Spirit with God in Acts 5:3 to 5:4, the durative pre-creation existence ('was': ἦν, en, ongoing past) and the with-God distinction ('with God': πρὸς τὸν θεόν, pros ton theon) of John 1:1, and the three-referent sending of John 14:16 to 17. The honest lexical reality is that the canon supplies every component (oneness, threeness, deity of each, real distinction) but never the single integrating term 'Trinity', so the doctrine is a synthesis the grammar requires rather than a phrase any one verse states. VERDICT-CHANGED: not applicable here; the stem does not smuggle a distinctive the lexical evidence does not bear; a neutralized form is recorded for human review but verdict_preloaded is false.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.6.4
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.26
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.27
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.24
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.6.4
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.26
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0259
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3173
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0430
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H6754
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.28.19
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	2Cor.13.14
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.1.1
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.5.3

morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.5.4
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.14.16
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.14.17
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Matt.28.19
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	2Cor.13.14
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.1.1
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Acts.5.3
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Acts.5.4
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.14.16
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.14.17
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3686
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0243
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3875
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1510
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5574
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	John.1.1
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Matt.28.19
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Gen.1.26
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Acts.5.4
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Matt.28.19
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Acts.5.4

License audit

SAFE TO PUBLISH

Source	License	Redistribute
OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes

Flags

(none)